

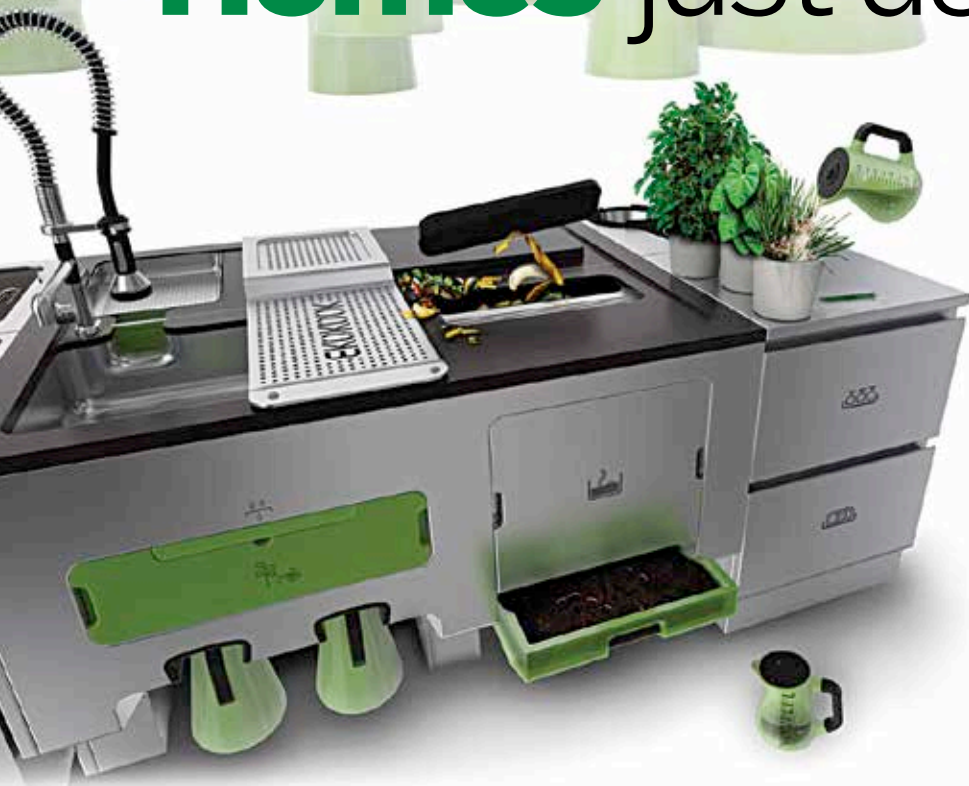
From the labs

Find out what a smart drug is, why the world is going crazy about them, and why they are also equally bizarre

Space age

With nuclear fusion powered rockets, you can fly to MARS in 30 days. Read on to find out more

Because **Normal Homes** just don't cut it



What some designers have in mind for our homes

capsule is that it will maintain the exact temperature required for that specific food item and it will remain independent of anything around it. Odours or particles of food won't get mixed. So in effect you could keep a bag of chicken right next to a bag of paneer and scare the living daylights out of a vegetarian who comes to visit you, after which you would sit them down with a cup of cocoa (which they would refuse because it was also placed next to the chicken) and explain to them how awesome this fridge is. Write to us and tell us if they were convinced. The creator also claims that it can be kept vertically and horizontally (which was pretty normal) but then proceeds to claim that it can also be kept on the ceiling (to which our jaws dropped) but only in a zero-gravity situation (to which we sighed). So if your home is in some weird corner of the world where even gravity can't reach you, this is the fridge for you.

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Now whenever we think of futuristic versions of well known appliances we tend to obsess over a lot of things but primarily we keep coming back to one thing: laziness. Now the battle between laziness and convenience is a battle we fight in our minds constantly to make us feel better about ourselves, and a clear winner must emerge for us to feel proud of what we have. The other factor is vanity. Well though there are a lot of justifications for it, the fact is that there is a large part of us which wants things to be shiny and good to look at- we call it aesthetics.

So, future appliances will stereotypically cater to our laziness and our need for things to be pretty. Electrolux Design Labs holds a competition every year for the

most consumer friendly, environmental friendly, and creative designs, and we have a picked some of the more interesting ones which have appeared over the years which have a chance of being more than just expensive mistakes. So have a look at what might make its way down the ramp into your kitchen soon, with photographers swarming all over them till they get into their shiny limousines and tell their chauffeur to drive off.

The Bio-Robot Refrigerator

Beautiful isn't it? Designed by Yuriv Dmitriev, the concept here is that the fridge cools biopolymer gel through luminescence. The gel is non sticky and odourless and when a food item is 'inserted' in it, a separate pod for it is created and it will lay suspended in that gel in a capsule which gets generated every time something is inserted into it. The speciality of the



Hard to believe this is a fridge, right?